

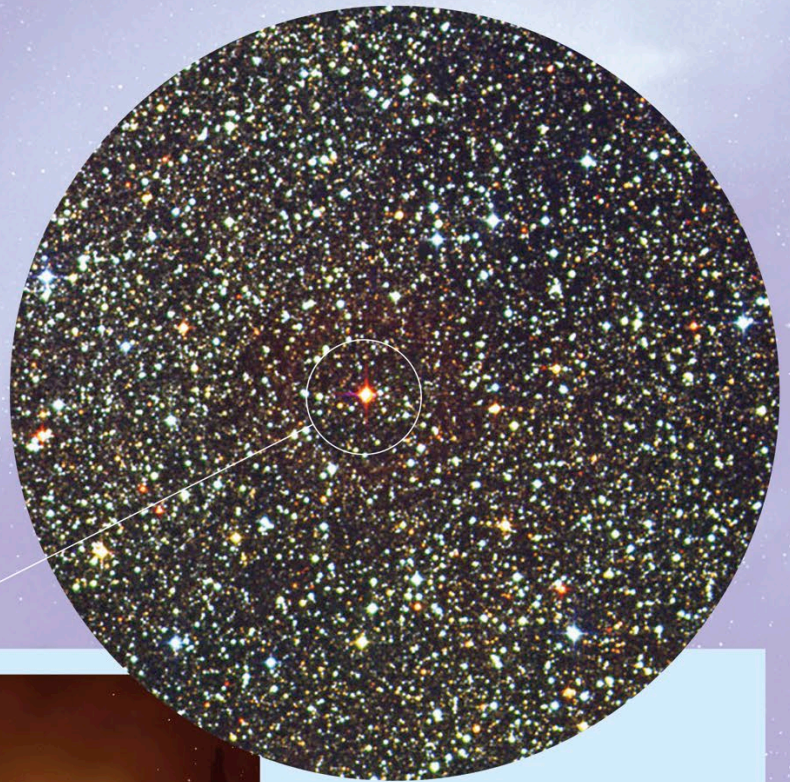


Why do stars twinkle?

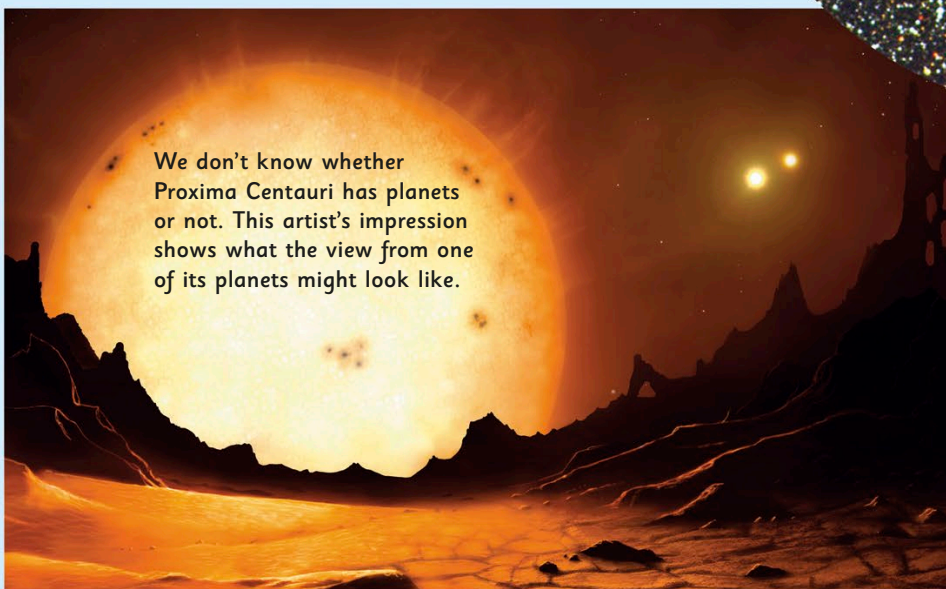
Stars twinkle because of movements in the Earth's atmosphere. Starlight enters the atmosphere as straight rays, but air moves the light's path so it appears to flicker or "twinkle".

Proxima Centauri

Proxima Centauri was only discovered in 1915. It's very faint, so it can't be seen without the aid of a telescope. It looks red because it's a red dwarf star.



Proxima Centauri



We don't know whether Proxima Centauri has planets or not. This artist's impression shows what the view from one of its planets might look like.

Nearest neighbours

Proxima Centauri lies in a group of three stars called Alpha Centauri. The others are Alpha Centauri A and Alpha Centauri B, which are both like our Sun, so experts believe they may have planets that support life.